

Tanner Contreras-Russell

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EXPERIENCE

Safety & Emergency Preparedness Specialist — Arizona Department of Health Services

03/2025 - Present

Lead and coordinate safety and emergency preparedness activities for staff, patients, contractors, and visitors, ensuring compliance with OSHA, The Joint Commission, NFPA, and state regulations. Proactively identify, correct, and follow up on safety deficiencies and hazards. Facilitate regular and ad hoc meetings with stakeholders, department leaders, and executives to provide updates on hospital operations and incidents.

- Develop, facilitate, and review the hospitals monthly, quarterly, and yearly emergency drills.
- Designed, developed, and implemented an Excel spreadsheet to aid in documenting, tracking, and correcting ligature risks throughout the hospital to prevent patient and staff harm
- Present data and trends to the Executive Management Team on safety and emergency management topics to help lead 'buy in' from the executives on important changes.

Central Monitoring Unit Supervisor — Nurses First Solutions

04/2023 - 03/2025

Supervise a team of 8–12 employees in cross-state EKG telemetry monitoring while supporting operational coordination between the Central Command Unit and partner hospitals. Serve as a liaison to hospital staff regarding policy questions, technical issues, and patient-specific requirements, ensuring clear communication and resolution of concerns. Facilitate meetings with incoming hospital leadership to explain remote cardiac monitoring workflows and coordinate expectations across facilities.

- Design, develop, and implement a comprehensive Emergency Action Plan for all three facility departments, along with quarterly safety meetings to support emergency readiness.
- Analyzed unfiltered data from Ascom notification software, organizing and charting results in Google Sheets/Excel to evaluate communication between the Central Monitoring Unit and partner hospitals, leading to a 35% improvement in alert acceptance rates.
- Facilitated meetings with incoming hospital leadership to address questions and provide detailed explanations of the remote cardiac monitoring process.

Wildland Firefighter Type-1 — Wildfire Defense Systems

05/2021 - 12/2022

Managed a team of 5-7 individual firefighters working under the command of Engine Bosses and a Task Force Leader in fire suppression efforts, emergency management, resource management, and overall safety during wildfire operations. Conducted and lead trainings for the Task Force to help with personal career development, repetition of required skills, and crisis communication.

- Assisted in managing the Task Force's \$50,000 seasonal budget by coordinating purchases, tracking expenses, and ensuring compliance with the company's Standard Operating Procedures.
- Collaborated with the Task Force Leader, Engine Bosses, and corporate leadership to coordinate and execute critical fire suppression efforts, successfully protecting a high-risk neighborhood outside our operational scope during the 2021 Dixie Complex Fire.
- Participated in operational briefings during incidents, liaised with Division Leads to coordinate deployment locations for Wildfire Defense Systems (WDS) representatives, programmed and distributed updated radio frequencies, and ensured clear communication of critical information to all crew members.

Emergency Medical Technician — Dispatch Health

03/2022 - 04/2023

EMT working one on one with a Nurse Practitioner or a Physician's Assistant to provide Urgent Care level treatment within patients homes. Scope includes; starting IV's, administering medications, obtaining vital signs, EKGs, wound care, splints, blood draws, urine analysis, and care coordination.

- Collaborated with leadership to streamline and enhance monthly training programs for the Greater Phoenix market, resulting in a 73% improvement in EMT skill proficiency and confidence.
- Developed and implemented a streamlined internal tracking system utilizing Google Sheets/Excel to efficiently monitor the usage, frequency, and inventory levels of medical supplies and medications, ensuring optimal resource management and compliance with industry standards.

EKG Monitor Technician — Banner Health

04/2019 - 03/2021

Monitor 45-60 patients continually per shift, reporting any cardiac arrhythmias to their respective nurse. In the event of a critical heart rhythm; Call Rapid Response Team, notify the Nurse, and prepare documentation. Ensure proper documentation and parameters are properly set for each patient to ensure it accounts for patients medical history and medications.

- Worked with hospital leadership into transitioning Standard Operating Procedures to better fit needs during the COVID-19 Pandemic.
- Trained to be an EKG Technician doing on-demand EKG's within patient's rooms during critical or abnormal continuous cardiac changes.

EDUCATION

Bachelors of Applied Science: Public Safety Administration — Maricopa County Community College

Summa Cum Laude

Associates in Applied Science: Fire Science — Maricopa County Community College

Certificate of Completion: Fire Operations — Maricopa County Community College

Certificate of Achievement: Peer Support Specialist — Rio Salado Community College

CERTIFICATIONS

Advanced Professional Series — FEMA's Emergency Management Institute

Specialist in Safety & Health Certificate — ASU OSHA

Professional Development Series — FEMA's Emergency Management Institute

Firefighter 1 & 2 — Arizona State Fire Training Committee

VOLUNTEER

AzCHER Central Region Member — Arizona Coalition for Healthcare Emergency Response

AzVOAD Affiliate Member — Arizona Volunteer Organizations Active In Disaster

Chair of the Commission on Diverse Cultures — City of Glendale